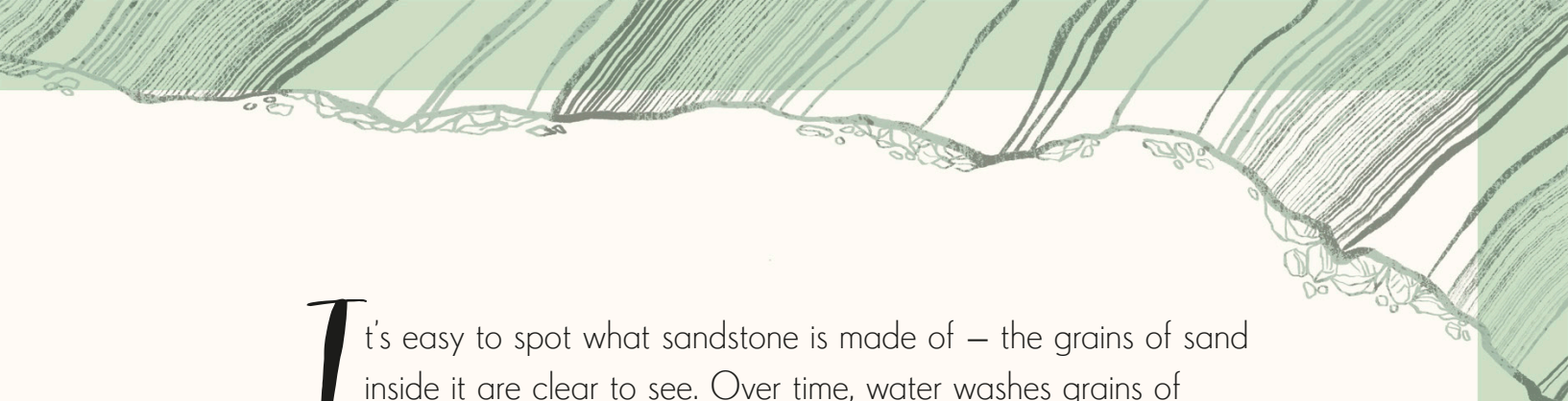




It's easy to spot what sandstone is made of – the grains of sand inside it are clear to see. Over time, water washes grains of other rocks into rivers, which sweep them into lakes and seas. The sand piles up, layer upon layer, like a giant sandwich. The weight of the layers above squash the ones below, until the minerals inside join together. This means sandstone won't fall apart when it gets wet like a sandcastle will!

In the middle of Australia, rising high above the desert, is a rock called Uluru. Uluru is one big chunk of red sandstone. It is as long as 30 football pitches, but this is only the tip of a massive layer of sandstone hidden below the ground.

